

Change Request 3 — Restore Windows Taskbar / Start Menu to Center

Change Request · Prepared by IT / Endpoint Configuration · 2026-07-13

Impact	3 - Low
Model	Normal
Type	Normal
State	New
Conflict status	Not Run
Conflict last run	—
Assignment group	End User Computing / Desktop Support (<i>confirm</i>)
Assigned to	[To be completed]
Business/Product User 1	[To be completed]
Business/Product User 2	[To be completed]
Security Team Approval	Not required — cosmetic desktop layout setting (<i>confirm</i>)

Short description

Restore Windows 11 taskbar / Start menu alignment to Center.

Description

During the Windows 10 → Windows 11 migration, the taskbar and Start button defaulted to the center (the Windows 11 default). Because users were not yet accustomed to the centered position, it was moved to the left to match the familiar Windows 10 layout. Users have since adjusted to Windows 11, and this change restores the taskbar/Start menu to the standard centered position.

Planning

Justification

Users have acclimated to Windows 11, and the centered taskbar is the standard, intended layout for the operating system.

Implementation plan

1. Set taskbar alignment to Center via Intune/registry (TaskbarAl = 1 under HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced ; 1 = Center, 0 = Left).

2. Deploy via policy/script and restart Explorer (or apply at next logon).
3. Pilot group first, then broad rollout in rings.
4. Confirm application through management reporting.

Risk and impact analysis

Low risk, cosmetic only. No functional or data impact. Fully reversible.

Backout plan

Set `TaskbarAl = 0` (Left) and refresh policy; restarting Explorer or logging back on restores the left-aligned layout.

Test plan

Apply the setting on a pilot device and confirm the Start button and taskbar icons are centered after logon, with no other changes to the desktop.

Schedule

Planned start	[To be completed]
Planned end	[To be completed]
Maintenance window	[To be completed]

Conflicts

Conflict check not yet run (status: Not Run). No known conflicting changes.

Notes

Recommend a brief user communication ahead of rollout so the moved Start button is expected.

Closure Information

Production Validation Details

Confirm on a sample of production machines that the taskbar/Start menu is centered after the change.

Major User Impact Details

Visual change — the Start button and taskbar icons move to the center of the taskbar. Communicate to users beforehand to avoid confusion.

Monitoring Details

Monitor the service desk for confusion reports and confirm the setting applied via Intune/GPO reporting.

Fields marked [To be completed] are organization-specific and should be filled in before submission.